Lesson 03 material: Grammar: Simple Present, Simple Past and Present Perfect

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 1: Academic Writing Essentials · Psychology

1.4: Grammar Presentation-Simple Present, Simple Past, and Present Perfect Tenses

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.1.4.1. Simple Present

The simple present is used for the following situations:

1. General facts

The Earth rotates on its axis.

2. Routines/habits

She practices gratitude every day.

3. Feelings

He enjoys hiking.

4. Possessions

Yun-Ji has a car.

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Verb Tenses: Simple Present

Video: https://youtu.be/Vyls_R3n1Cw

1.1.4.1.1. Exercise 3-All About You

Tell me all about you! Answer the questions about yourself. Use the simple present tense.

1. Where are you from, and where do you live now?
2. What languages do you speak?
3. What are your hobbies?
4. How do you feel about taking this class?
5. What do you like about Reedley College?
6. What are your goals?
7. What do you do every day?
8. Tell me about the people who are close to you (relationships).
9. Do you have a pet?
10. What else should I know about you?

1.1.4.1.2. Subject-Verb Agreement

When writing sentences in the simple present, keep in mind that third-person singular subjects (he, she, it) have verbs that are modified differently than verbs of other subjects. Look at the examples below.

1. Mika plays video games.
2. You play video games.

The first example has a third-person singular subject (Mika-she), so the verb is modified by adding -s. The second example has a second-person singular subject (you), so the verb is not modified. Verbs for third-person singular subject can be modified in three ways.

1. add -s (play-plays)
2. add -es/-ies (miss-misses/study-studies)
3. irregular (have-has, do-does)

1.1.4.1.2.1. Exercise 4-Subject-Verb Agreement

Select the appropriate verb form to complete the sentence.

1. Shpresa _____ letters to her boyfriend during class.
   a. write
   b. writes
2. We _____ to register for classes before the deadline.
   a. have
   b. has

3. Merita and Besart _____ to give their presentation first.
    a. want
    b. wants
4. You _____ very well. The food is delicious!
    a. cook
    b. cooks
5. Issra _____ her homework immediately after class.
    a. do
    b. does
6. I _____ by practicing the concepts many times.
    a. learn
    b. learns
7. Ivana's book _____ a lot.
    a. weigh
    b. weighs
8. The flowers _____ smell beautiful!
    a. smell
    b. smells
9. Alamdar _____ twins.
    a. have
    b. has
10. Yulee _____ French.
    a. study
    b. studies

1.1.4.2. Simple Past

The simple past is used to show a completed action in the past. This tense is often used with signal words or phrases that tell when something happened. Example signal phrases include yesterday, [length of time] + ago, and last [night, week, month, year, or a specific day].

1. Yesterday, Victoria went to the bank.
2. Three months ago, Ayman visited Los Angeles, California.
3. Last week, we studied paragraphs.

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Verb Tenses: Simple Past

Video: https://youtu.be/0W8nKdeBE9w

1.1.4.2.1. Exercise 5-All About the Past You

Tell me all about what you did! Answer the questions about yourself. Use the simple past tense.

1. What did you eat for dinner yesterday?
2. What did you do last weekend?
3. When did you enroll at Reedley College?
4. Did you play a sport as a child? If so, which sport?
5. What did you enjoy when you were a child?

1.1.4.3. Present Perfect

The present perfect has five uses:

1. The time of the event is unknown.

Anastasiya has eaten sushi.

2. The action is unfinished and continues at present time.

Kyaw and Sunil have been friends for several years.

3. The action has been repeated several times in the past.

Rafael and Jianhua have been absent many times this semester.

4. An uncompleted action is expected to finish.

The package still hasn't arrived.

5. An action has happened recently.

The children have just woken up.

In the first example, we don't know when Anastasiya ate sushi. We know that this action happened in the past and is finished. In the second example, Kyaw and Sunil were friends in the past, and they continue to be friends. In the third example, Rafael and Jianhua have repeated the action of being absent. In the fourth example, the package is expected, but it still has not arrived. In the final example, the action happened recently.

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Verb Tenses: Present Perfect

Video: https://youtu.be/pMG9Yyr8kfU

1.1.4.3.1. Exercise 6-Simple Present or Present Perfect?

Complete the sentences below using the simple present or present perfect.

1. Katayoon is a writer. She _____ many books.
   a. wrote
   b. has written
2. Njomza is a teacher. Last semester, she _____ our algebra class.
   a. taught
   b. has taught
3. Lina and Andrius _____ in the classroom since 8:00 AM.
   a. were
   b. have been
4. Zaire's phone _____ class three time already.
   a. interrupted
   b. has interrupted
5. Abena _____ on a rollercoaster. She loves adventure!
   a. rode
   b. has ridden
6. Xuan and Wen _____ the teacher's office after class so that they can better understand the topics covered during the lecture.
   a. visited
   b. have visited
7. Aida _____ her project two weeks ago.
   a. finished
   b. has finished
8. Naoko _____ her project.
   a. finished
   b. has just finished
9. Ravneet _____ her boss five times. She wants to tell her boss that she will be absent at work today.
   a. called
   b. has called
10. Yara _____ two exams, an essay, and a presentation so far this week.
    a. had
    b. has had
11. When I was a child, I _____ every day during the summer.
    a. swam
    b. have swum
12. Since I was a child, I _____ an interest in learning.
    a. had
    b. have had
13. Which cities _____ ?
    a. did you visit
    b. have you visited
14. I _____ to San Francisco last month and Sacramento in February.
    a. went
    b. have gone

1.1.4.3.2. Exercise 7-What have you done?

Answer the questions telling me more about what you have done. Use the present perfect in your answers. Share your answers with your class.

1. Have you ever broken a bone?
2. Have you ever eaten raw fish or meat?
3. Have you ever found a wallet or money that someone dropped?

4. Have you ever done an extreme sport like sky diving or bungee jumping?
5. How long have you been in this city?
6. How long have you been in this country?
7. How long have you studied English?

1.1.4.4. Exercise 8-Verb Tense Review

Select the appropriate verb to complete the sentences. Notice the signal words in some sentences. In some cases, two answers are possible.

1. I _____ [live] in Mexico when I was a child.
   a. live
   b. lived
   c. have lived
2. My parents _____ [live] in California.
   a. live
   b. lived
   c. have lived
3. The students _____ [do] a grammar exercise every day this week.
   a. do
   b. did
   c. have done
4. Noor _____ [just/find] $20.
   a. just finds
   b. just found
   c. has just found
5. My family _____ [go] on vacation once a year.
   a. goes
   b. went
   c. has gone
6. I _____ [take] four classes last semester.
   a. take
   b. took
   c. have taken
7. My best friend _____ [send] me letters regularly.
   a. sends
   b. sent
   c. has sent
8. Last night, I _____ [do] my homework between 9:30 and 11 pm.
   a. do
   b. did
   c. have done
9. My brother _____ [go] to the park with his daughter.
   a. goes
   b. went
   c. has gone
10. We _____ [love] to study grammar!
    a. love
    b. loved
    c. have loved

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1.1.4.5. Exercise 9-Error Analysis of Simple Present, Simple Past, and Present Perfect

Correct the errors below.

1. Balkaran has visited his uncle yesterday.
2. Preet studied every morning before his class begins.
3. Laila cooks lunch last Sunday.
4. The college offers ESL classes on Saturdays, but now it didn't.
5. José studied at Reedley College for three semesters. Next semester, he will transfer.

Links on the original page

- Verb Tenses: Simple Present: https://youtu.be/Vyls_R3n1Cw
- Verb Tenses: Simple Past: https://youtu.be/0W8nKdeBE9w
- Verb Tenses: Present Perfect: https://youtu.be/pMG9Yyr8kfU

1.5: Applying Grammar to Reading

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.1.5.1. Exercise 10-Identifying Verb Tenses

Reread the paragraphs from this chapter's reading. Highlight or circle the verbs taking note of their tense. Put the verbs in the table according to their tense. Use the example to guide you.

1You walk into school and realize you forgot your math homework. Then, the teacher starts the lesson. Some of it makes sense, but some parts leave you scratching your head. You turn to the student next to you for help and realize it's your best friend who moved away in second grade. Then, you wake up. You were dreaming.

2Dreams can be exciting or terrifying. Often, they are complicated and confusing. And for much of human history, we've tried to make sense of them. The ancient Egyptians believed that dreams were messages from the gods. The ancient Greeks and Romans believed that dreams showed prophecies, or visions of the future. Later, in the 1800s, early psychologists believed that dreams centered on thoughts that people wanted to avoid, windows into what they called the "unconscious mind."

3Today, scientists still aren't exactly sure why we have dreams, but a number of theories have emerged. One idea is that we dream to "practice" responding to problems. This is called "threat simulation theory" and might explain why our dreams so often involve stressful events such as forgetting your homework. Scientists believe that your brain might be preparing for how it would respond if you really do forget your homework. These scientists point out that humans aren't the only animals who dream; if you've ever seen a dog moving its legs while it's sleeping, it's probably dreaming about running.

Simple Present	**Simple Past**	**Present Perfect**
walk	believed	have tried ('ve tried)

Table 1 Exercise 10 Identifying Verb Tenses

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1.1.5.2. Exercise 11-Pronunciation of Simple Past Verbs

There are three ways to pronounce -ed added to verbs to form the simple past. It depends on the preceding sound. The table below will describe the rules for each sound. The rules include the terms voiceless and voiced. This refers to the vibration of your vocal cords. You can determine whether a sound is voiced or voiceless by putting your hand on your throat. If you feel a vibration, then the sound is voiced. If there's no vibration, then the sound is voiceless.

Pronunciation	**Rule**	**Examples**												
/t/	The final sound is pronounce /t/ after voiceless sounds /p/ /k/, /f/, /s/, /ʃ/, and /ʧ/.	shopped	baked	laughed	kissed	pushed	punched							
/d/	The final sound is pronounced /d/ after the voiced sounds /b/, /g/, /v/, /z/, /m/, /n/, /l/, /r/, /ŋ/, /ð/, /ʒ/, and /ʤ/.	The final sound is pronounced /d/ after all vowel sounds.	robbed	chugged	loved	prayed	used	chimed	canned	called	spurred	banged	bathed	changed
/Id/	The final sound is /Id/ after the sounds /t/ and /d/.	/Id/ adds a syllable to the verb.	needed	wanted										

Table 2 Pronunciation of -ed

Reread the paragraphs from this chapter's reading. Identify the simple past verbs and put them in the appropriate column in the table below. Use the examples to guide you.

7Regardless of why we dream, scientists agree that dreams can have many benefits. One group of scientists proved that dreams could help people solve complex problems. These scientists provided a group of people with a difficult-to-solve maze. Afterwards, they allowed the group members to take a break, with half of the participants being shown a video and the other half being told to nap. Ninety minutes later, everyone returned to the maze. In general, the nappers and the video-watchers performed about the same when they returned to the maze. But the nappers who reported dreaming about the maze were ten times better at completing it than anyone else.

8Dreams have also long been considered sources for inspiration. Paul McCartney, a former lead singer of the band The Beatles, said the idea for the famous song "Yesterday" came to him in a dream. He said he woke up thinking of the tune, and then immediately rushed to the piano to figure out the notes and write them down.

9Similarly, in the late 1600s, the philosopher and scientist René Descartes spent all day in a heated room, searching for the best way to come up with new knowledge. Without a solution at the end of the day, he put down his work and went to sleep. When he woke up, he recalled from his dreams the scientific method — the same process for experiments still taught in schools today.

/t/	**/d/**	**/Id/**	**Irregular Past Tense**
rushed	proved	provided	were

Table 3 Identifying Pronunciation of -ed

1.6: Communication Practice

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.1.6.1. Exercise 12-Do, Did, Have Done

Work with a partner. Assign numbers for you and your partner (Partner 1 and Partner 2). Ask your partner questions about what they do, did, and have done. Partner 1 will answer Partner 2's questions using information from the table Partner 1 Profile. Partner 2 will answer Partner 1's questions using information from the table Partner 2 Profile. Use the simple present, simple past, and present perfect for your answers. If time allows, report your partner's answers to the class.

Questions:

What do you do every day?

What did you do yesterday?

What did you do at 6:30 AM?

What have you already done today?

Partner 1 Profile:

Day/Time	**Activity**
Every day	exercise
Yesterday	go to my friend's birthday party
5:30 AM	go for a run at a nearby park
6:30 AM	take a shower
7:00 AM	leave for school
8:00 AM	attend writing class
10:30 AM	attend math class
Now	study grammar

Table 4 Partner Profile 1

Partner 2 Profile:

Day/Time	**Activity**
Every day	call my mom
Yesterday	make cookies
6:30 AM	press the snooze on my alarm
7:00 AM	get out of bed
7:45 AM	eat breakfast
8:15 AM	arrive last for writing class
9:00 AM	study at the library
10:00 AM	have an exam in my history class
Now	study grammar

Table 5 Partner Profile 2

1.1.6.2. Exercise 13-Interview a Classmate

Interview a classmate. Ask questions about their current situation and past. Write a short paragraph introducing your partner to the rest of the class. Look at the topics below to guide you.

- name
- country of origin
- current city
- arrival to USA or this city
- classes this semester

- previous classes
- length of time studying English
- hobbies and interests

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Irregular Verbs

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Irregular verbs in English are common. Unfortunately, using them correctly takes memorization. Fortunately, many irregular verbs follow a pattern. Throughout the semester, you will complete exercises that will help you memorize these irregular verbs. Use this table as a reference.

5.2.1. Group 1

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
bet	bet	bet	betting
cost	cost	cost	costing
cut	cut	cut	cutting
hit	hit	hit	hitting
hurt	hurt	hurt	hurting
let	let	let	letting
put	put	put	putting
shut	shut	shut	shutting

Table 22 Group 1 Irregular Verbs

5.2.2. Group 2

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
ring	rang	rung	ringing
sing	sang	sung	singing
drink	drank	drunk	drinking
sink	sank	sunk	sinking
swim	swam	swum	swimming
begin	began	begun	beginning

Table 23 Group 2 Irregular Verbs

5.2.3. Group 3

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
know	knew	known	
grow	grew	grown	growing
blow	blew	blown	blowing
throw	threw	thrown	throwing
fly	flew	flown	flying
show	showed	shown	showing
draw	drew	drawn	drawing

Table 24 Group 3 Irregular Verbs

5.2.4. Group 4

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
think	thought	thought	thinking
teach	taught	taught	teaching
buy	bought	bought	buying
fight	fought	fought	fighting
catch	caught	caught	catching

bring	brought	brought	brining

Table 25 Group 4 Irregular Verbs

5.2.5. Group 5

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
give	gave	given	giving
write	wrote	written	writing
take	took	taken	taking
fall	fell	fallen	falling
drive	drove	driven	driving
eat	ate	eaten	eating
ride	rode	ridden	riding
rise	rose	risen	rising
forgive	forgave	forgiving	forgiving

Table 26 Group 5 Irregular Verbs

5.2.6. Group 6

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
steal	stole	stolen	stealing
speak	spoke	spoken	speaking
choose	chose	chosen	choosing
break	broke	broken	breaking
freeze	froze	frozen	freezing
get	got	gotten	getting
forget	forgot	forgotten	forgetting
bite	bit	bitten	biting
hide	hid	hidden	hiding
beat	beat	beaten	beating
prove	proved	proven	proving

Table 27 Group 6 Irregular Verbs

5.2.7. Group 7

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
send	sent	sent	sending
spend	spent	spent	spending
lend	lent	lent	lending
build	built	built	building
lose	lost	lost	losing
mean	meant	meant	meaning

Table 28 Group 7 Irregular Verbs

5.2.8. Group 8

Base form	**Past Tense**	**Past Participle**	**Present Participle**
pay	paid	paid	paying
say	said	said	saying
sell	sold	sold	selling
tell	sold	told	telling

stand	stood	stood	standing
sleep	slept	slept	sleeping
keep	kept	kept	keeping
feel	felt	felt	feeling

Table 29 Group 8 Irregular Verbs